



MONTHLY UPDATE

Guinea-Bissau: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 • 6 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • DPI • DATA

Summary of the month

Three developments were recorded between 1 July and 19 August 2026. [The Instituto Nacional de Estatística released preliminary RGPH4 census results](#) on 23 July, putting the resident population at 2,191,202 – the country's first new population baseline since 2009 and its first fully digital census. The next day, [AUDA-NEPAD launched its Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#) at a ministerial segment in Abidjan, naming Guinea-Bissau among seven island states under a 2026–2031 roadmap that includes digital transformation as one of six pillars. In August [the government approved a national interoperability regulation](#), the first movement on a decree that had stood approved in draft since July 2025.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The digital integrity law was [passed unanimously with amendments by the transitional parliament on 21 May, framed by the government spokesman as targeting those who spread hate and act against the State](#), with enforcement mechanisms, including for citizens abroad, left unstated. Its publication and in-force dates are unconfirmed. It was [first invoked on 21 July by the communications ministry over a false claim that TikTok was being shut down in the country](#) – the first use the base records, and it is the state correcting a claim about itself.

Regional collaboration

[AUDA-NEPAD launched the Programme for African Developing Island Economies](#) at the Ministerial Segment of the Specialized Technical Committee on Trade, Industry and Minerals in Abidjan on 24 July 2026, covering Guinea-Bissau alongside Cabo Verde, the Comoros, Madagascar, Mauritius, Sao Tome and Principe and Seychelles. A 2026–2031 roadmap groups the seven states under six pillars, including connectivity and AfCFTA integration and digital transformation – with digital public infrastructure, artificial intelligence and automation named as accelerators. Ministers adopted a communique committing to the programme; no Guinea-Bissau-specific national action under it has yet been reported.

DPI

Data Exchange

[The government approved a national interoperability regulation](#), announced on 8 August 2026 by the World Bank-backed Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program, which supports the work and presents the framework as Guinea-Bissau's contribution to the regional programme. A draft decree on the interoperability of public and

private digital systems had been approved by the Council of Ministers on 10 July 2025 and had not moved since; the announcement names no decree number, no gazettal and no entry-into-force date, and the paired data-governance and cybersecurity decrees approved alongside it in 2025 remain where they were.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Guinea-Bissau's connection to the regional instant-payment rail widened. The BCEAO's [participant list of 31 July 2026](#) records five institutions authorised to open PI-SPI services to the public - Banco da Africa Ocidental, BDU, Coris Bank, Ecobank and Orabank - against three when the platform opened to the public in September 2025. Guinea-Bissau and Niger hold the joint-smallest national counts on a union list that has more than doubled over the same period, to 104 participants across the eight WAEMU states.

Registries

The register moved without the electorate changing. The electoral support office [handed the updated register to the elections commission in physical and electronic form for the 30 August referendum, recording 966,152 registered voters — unchanged from the last update](#), having also issued 25,146 replacement voter cards in a 30-day nationwide operation from 13 July to 11 August through 51 brigades covering every region. So the month's work was replacing credentials rather than adding registrants, and no audit or de-duplication statement accompanies the handover.

Data

National statistics

The Instituto Nacional de Estatistica released [RGPH4 preliminary results on 23 July 2026](#), putting resident population at 2,191,202 — cut from a raw collected base of 2,246,300 after correction for repeated names, against 1,449,230 in 2009. [50.7% are women and 45.7% urban; 304,939 households, 559,303 dwellings and 376,258 buildings were enumerated, using computer-assisted personal interviewing throughout](#). UNFPA and the World Bank financed the census; demographic, social, economic and housing tabulations are to be released progressively over the coming months.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-27
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GNB/GNB-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GNB/GNB-monthly-2026-08-27.pdf
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